

EcoLegis:
Legislative Document Management & AI Summary System

In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Degree of
Bachelor of Science in Information System

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY



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Chapter 1

Introduction

Project Context

The continuing expansion of information and communication technologies has changed how organizations create, store, process, and share information. In government offices, many activities still depend on large volumes of printed documents, particularly in meetings where agendas, legislative dockets, supporting documents, and minutes must be reviewed by several participants. When the amount of information increases, users may spend more time searching, reading, and comparing documents before a discussion can proceed. These conditions create opportunities for information systems that can organize legislative documents digitally while making important information easier to access and understand.

Recent Philippine research on local legislative bodies has examined the transition from paper-based sessions to digital or paperless operations. Gabuya (2025), for example, reported that paperless legislative practices can be associated with perceived benefits such as efficiency, environmental sustainability, cost-effectiveness, and improved record management, while also identifying challenges involving infrastructure, digital literacy, platform familiarity, and institutional support. These findings provide a relevant context for developing a digital legislative document system for a city legislative office.

The City Government of Malolos identifies the Sangguniang Panlungsod and its councilors as part of the city government structure, including an office for the Secretary to the Sangguniang Panlungsod. The legislative environment therefore involves documents that must be prepared, distributed, reviewed, and accessed by authorized personnel during official sessions.

EcoLegis: Legislative Document Management & AI Summary System is proposed as a digital platform that supports this setting by allowing authorized administrators or SP personnel to upload PDF copies of the Order of Business or legislative dockets. The documents can then be accessed through devices such as tablets provided by the institution. In addition to preserving access to the original document, the system introduces an AI-assisted summarization function that identifies and condenses important points from each topic so that users can obtain an overview before reading the complete material.

A central concern addressed by the project is information overload. Instead of requiring a user to read every page of a lengthy legislative docket before understanding its general direction, EcoLegis is intended to present a shorter, adjustable summary while retaining access to the raw



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document. The user may select the desired level of summary detail and may return to the original, unsummarized document when a fuller understanding is required. This design treats AI summarization as an aid to document review rather than as a replacement for the official source.

The project also supports a paper-reduction objective. By making legislative documents available electronically during sessions, the system may reduce the need to print multiple copies of the same material for participants. The intended result is a workflow that is more convenient for document access, more manageable for users reviewing dense materials, and more supportive of a gradual transition toward a paper-light or paperless legislative session.

Purpose and Description

The primary purpose of EcoLegis is to provide the Sangguniang Panlungsod of Malolos City with a centralized digital means of distributing and reviewing legislative session documents. The system is intended to replace a document-review workflow that relies heavily on printed copies with a controlled digital workflow in which authorized personnel can access the same legislative materials using approved devices.

The system operates by receiving PDF files containing the Order of Business, legislative dockets, or related session documents from an authorized administrator or designated SP personnel. Once a document is made available, users can open it from their device and view either an AI-generated summary or the raw document. The AI summarization component is intended to extract or generate the most relevant points from a topic and present them in a shorter form. The user can select the level of detail desired, depending on whether a quick overview or a more detailed summary is needed.

EcoLegis is also designed around controlled access. Availability of a session document after the session is not assumed to be permanent; continued access depends on the permissions established by the SP or system administrator. This provides the institution with control over who may continue to view specific legislative materials after a session while maintaining the raw document as the reference source for authorized users.

The system is therefore positioned as a document-management and decision-support tool for legislative sessions. It does not replace the official legislative document, the deliberative process of the council, or the judgment of authorized officials. Instead, it provides a digital workspace intended to make legislative information more accessible, organized, and easier to review within the session workflow.



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Statement of the Problem

The conduct of legislative sessions involves the review of various documents, including the Order of Business and legislative dockets. The traditional process of distributing and reviewing these documents may require the use of numerous printed materials and may make it difficult for users to quickly identify the most important information contained in lengthy legislative documents. This may contribute to slower document review, increased paper consumption, and cognitive overload among users during legislative sessions.

To address these concerns, the study proposes EcoLegis: Legislative Document Management & AI Summary System, a system designed to digitize legislative documents and provide AI-assisted summaries to help users review and understand legislative materials more efficiently.

Specifically, this study seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What problems are encountered in the existing process of handling and reviewing legislative documents during sessions?
2. How can EcoLegis digitize and manage legislative documents such as the Order of Business and legislative dockets to reduce reliance on printed materials?
3. How can the AI summarization feature of EcoLegis provide concise and understandable summaries of legislative documents while retaining their key points and important details?
4. How can the system allow users to adjust the level of detail of the generated summaries according to their needs?
5. How can EcoLegis allow users to access the original, unsummarized legislative documents for further review and verification?
6. How can the system support authorized users in reviewing legislative documents more efficiently and help reduce cognitive overload during legislative sessions?
7. How can EcoLegis manage user access to legislative documents after the conclusion of a session, based on the permissions granted by the administrator or the Sangguniang Panlungsod?
8. How acceptable is the proposed EcoLegis system to its intended users in terms of functionality, usability, efficiency, and usefulness?



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Objectives

General Objective. To design and develop EcoLegis: Legislative Document Management & AI Summary System as a digital platform for managing legislative session documents and providing AI-assisted summaries for authorized users of the Sangguniang Panlungsod of Malolos City.

Specifically, the project aims to:

1. digitize the distribution and viewing of Orders of Business, legislative dockets, and related session documents by providing electronic access through authorized devices;
2. provide an organized mechanism for authorized administrators or SP personnel to upload and make PDF legislative documents available to users;
3. generate concise AI-assisted summaries that identify key points and important details from legislative topics;
4. allow users to select the desired level of summary detail according to their information needs;
5. allow users to switch between the summarized view and the original raw document for deeper review and verification;
6. support access control so that continued access to session materials after a session can be managed according to SP or administrator permissions;
7. help reduce reliance on printed copies of legislative session materials and support a more paper-light legislative workflow; and
8. provide a document-review environment intended to help users process lengthy legislative information more efficiently and reduce unnecessary cognitive load during sessions.

Scope and Limitations

The scope of EcoLegis covers the digital management and review of legislative session documents for the intended users of the Sangguniang Panlungsod of Malolos City. The system includes the uploading of PDF-based Orders of Business or legislative dockets by authorized personnel, electronic viewing of documents through supported devices, AI-assisted summarization of document content, adjustable summary detail, viewing of the original document, and permission-based continuation of access after a session.

The project is limited by the following conditions:



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1. The system is dependent on the availability and quality of the uploaded PDF documents. Poor scans, incomplete files, or documents with difficult-to-process text may affect the quality of generated summaries.
2. AI-generated summaries are intended as aids to document review and are not treated as substitutes for the official legislative document. Users remain responsible for checking the raw document when exact wording, context, or legal detail is important.
3. The project does not replace the authority of the Sangguniang Panlungsod to deliberate, decide, approve, or interpret legislative matters.
4. Access to documents after a session depends on the permissions established by the SP or system administrator; therefore, not all users are assumed to retain indefinite access.
5. The current project scope is centered on PDF-based legislative materials. Other document formats, automated minute-taking, legislative voting, and broader records-management functions are outside the stated scope unless added in a later version.
6. The actual effectiveness of the system will also depend on user readiness, device availability, connectivity, and institutional policies governing the use of digital legislative materials.

Definition of Terms

AI Summarization. the use of artificial intelligence to condense a longer document into a shorter representation that highlights important information.

Artificial Intelligence (AI). computer-based methods that perform tasks associated with human intelligence, such as language processing, information extraction, and text generation.

Cognitive Load. the amount of mental processing required from a person while handling information. In this project, the term relates to the effort needed to review lengthy and information-dense legislative materials.

Document Management. the organized process of storing, controlling, accessing, and handling electronic documents throughout their permitted use.

EcoLegis. the proposed Legislative Document Management & AI Summary System developed for the intended legislative-session workflow.

Legislative Docket. a collection or listing of matters, proposed measures, communications, reports, and other documents prepared for legislative consideration during a session.

Order of Business. the organized sequence or agenda of matters to be taken up during a legislative session.



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Raw Document. the original uploaded legislative document presented without the AI-generated summary.

Summary Detail Level. the user-selected amount of information presented in an AI-generated summary, ranging from a shorter overview to a more detailed explanation.

Sangguniang Panlungsod (SP). the city legislative body of the City of Malolos and the institutional client identified for this project.

Authorized User. a person who has been granted permission by the system administrator or the SP to access particular legislative documents or system functions.

Paper-Light or Paperless Workflow. a document-handling process that reduces or minimizes the use of printed copies by using digital documents and electronic devices.



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Chapter 2

Review of Related Studies and Technical Background

This chapter reviews selected studies and concepts relevant to digital legislative document management, paperless government workflows, automatic text summarization, and the reduction of unnecessary information-processing demands during document review. It also presents the technical background that supports the proposed EcoLegis system.

Related Studies

Paperless and digital legislative sessions. Gabuya (2025) examined the readiness of the Sangguniang Bayan of LGU Motiong for paperless sessions. The study identified perceived benefits such as efficiency, environmental sustainability, cost-effectiveness, and improved record management, while also identifying infrastructure, platform familiarity, digital literacy, and institutional support as important adoption concerns. The findings are relevant to EcoLegis because the proposed system similarly aims to move legislative document review from printed copies toward controlled digital access.

Electronic document management in government. Hung, Tang, Chang, and Ke (2009) studied user acceptance of an electronic document management system in an intergovernmental-service context and emphasized that technological implementation alone does not determine success; users' acceptance and willingness to use the system are important. For EcoLegis, this supports the inclusion of an accessible user interface, clear document access procedures, and evaluation of the actual experience of intended users rather than focusing only on technical functionality.

Legal and legislative document summarization. Sagum, Clacio, Cayetano, and Lobrio (2023) developed a Philippine Court Case Summarizer using Latent Semantic Analysis to condense legal documents. Their work demonstrates the applicability of text summarization within the Philippine legal context and shows that local legal documents can be processed to identify and represent important content in shorter form. EcoLegis applies a related idea to legislative-session documents, particularly Orders of Business and legislative dockets.

Extractive and abstractive approaches. Shukla et al. (2022) examined extractive and abstractive methods for legal case-document summarization and highlighted the challenge of handling long, specialized legal texts. More recent research continues to investigate hybrid and



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large-language-model approaches. Patel, Patil, Vora, and Shahade (2026) reported that legal document summarization remains challenging because of dense and lengthy text, while their study explored a hybrid architecture combining extractive and abstractive methods. These studies suggest that summarization systems for legislative documents should prioritize important content while remaining attentive to the complexity and context of the source material.

Source fidelity and human review. Nazly and Yapa (2026) reviewed the evolution of legal-document summarization from extractive techniques to transformer and large-language-model approaches. Their review notes that fluency does not by itself guarantee factual or legal faithfulness and points to the importance of grounding, traceability, and human review. This principle is directly relevant to EcoLegis because the original legislative document remains accessible to users and the generated summary is positioned as an aid for review rather than as the authoritative source.

Cognitive load and information processing. Sweller (1988) explained that human cognitive processing capacity is limited and that tasks requiring substantial mental processing can compete with other cognitive demands. In the context of legislative sessions, lengthy and information-dense documents can require users to spend significant effort locating and processing relevant information. EcoLegis addresses this concern by providing an adjustable summary while retaining access to the complete document, allowing users to choose between a quick overview and deeper reading.

Synthesis of related studies. The reviewed literature suggests three connected directions that inform EcoLegis: first, public-sector organizations can benefit from digital document and paperless workflows; second, automatic summarization can reduce the amount of text that must be processed at once; and third, summarization in legal or legislative contexts requires careful attention to source fidelity and human verification. The proposed system combines these directions in one workflow by pairing digital document access with configurable AI-assisted summaries and continued access to the raw legislative document.

Technical Background of the Project

EcoLegis is grounded in the intersection of document management, web-based information access, natural language processing, artificial intelligence, and human-centered information presentation. The project begins with a practical administrative need: the same legislative documents are currently prepared for multiple users who need to read and discuss them during a session. A digital system reduces the need to distribute multiple printed copies by making one controlled electronic document available to authorized users through their devices.



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The second technical idea is automatic text summarization. Summarization attempts to produce a shorter form of a document while preserving its most important information. In the EcoLegis setting, the goal is not to rewrite legislation or decide what an official should think about a measure. The goal is to provide a readable overview of the source so that users can identify key points before deciding whether to read the complete text. This distinction is important in legislative applications because the raw source remains necessary for exact wording and context.

The third technical idea is adjustable information presentation. Not every user requires the same amount of detail at the same time. A short summary may be sufficient for quickly scanning the Order of Business, while a more detailed summary may be appropriate for a topic that requires closer attention. Providing multiple summary-detail levels makes the interface responsive to the user's immediate information need and supports gradual movement from overview to full-document review.

Finally, the project includes access-control considerations. Legislative materials are not assumed to remain available to every user indefinitely. EcoLegis therefore treats document availability as a permission-based function, particularly after a session. This supports institutional control over digital legislative records while still allowing the system to serve as a practical session-review platform.

Technical Background of the System

From a functional perspective, EcoLegis can be described as a sequence of interconnected modules. The first module handles document submission, where an authorized administrator or designated SP personnel uploads a PDF Order of Business or legislative docket. The second module handles document access, allowing authorized users to open the material on a supported device. The third module handles AI-assisted summarization, where the content is processed into a shorter representation. The fourth module presents the summary at a user-selected level of detail. The fifth module maintains access to the raw document so that users can compare or verify the summary against the source. The final access-control layer determines whether users can continue viewing the material after the session according to the permissions established by the SP or administrator.

The user interface is intended for devices that can be used during legislative sessions, including tablets provided by the institution. The interface therefore needs to support quick navigation between documents, summaries, and original files without forcing the user through unnecessary steps. Clear labeling is particularly important because users may switch between a summarized view and the raw document while a discussion is already in progress.



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The summarization component should also be treated as a controlled information-processing layer. The generated output is dependent on the text that can be extracted or processed from the uploaded document and on the behavior of the AI method used by the system. For this reason, the system design maintains the original PDF as a reference and presents the summary as assistive information. This approach is consistent with current research that emphasizes source fidelity and human review for AI-generated legal or legal-adjacent text summaries (Nazly & Yapa, 2026).

In overall architecture, EcoLegis can therefore be viewed as a document-input, processing, presentation, and access-control pipeline. The combination of these functions is what distinguishes the proposed project from a simple PDF viewer or a standalone text summarizer: the project is intended to support the complete legislative document-review workflow, from upload to session use to post-session permission management.



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Chapter 3

Research Method

This chapter presents the research method for the development and evaluation of EcoLegis: Legislative Document Management & AI Summary System. It describes the design and development approach, research design, theoretical and conceptual framework, target clientele, research instruments, data gathering procedure, ethical considerations, and the development, testing, and implementation process of the proposed system.

Design and Development

The study will follow a design-and-development approach in which information gathered from intended users and representative legislative documents will be translated into system requirements and used as the basis for developing EcoLegis. The development process will focus on digitizing legislative documents, providing controlled document access, and supporting the review of lengthy legislative materials through AI-assisted summarization. The resulting system will be subjected to functional testing and user evaluation before the approved implementation or pilot activity.

Research Design

The study will employ a developmental research design supported by descriptive data-gathering activities. Interviews, observation, and document analysis will be used to identify workflow requirements and user needs, while functional testing and a system evaluation questionnaire will be used to assess the developed system. The evaluation will use a Likert-scale response format, such as Strongly Agree to Strongly Disagree, to obtain respondents' perceptions of relevant system quality criteria including functionality, usability, reliability, and maintainability, together with other criteria required by the study or institution.

Theoretical and Conceptual Framework

The study is grounded on the idea that a digital document-management workflow can reduce the dependence on printed legislative materials and improve access to session documents through authorized electronic devices. The AI summarization component is intended to provide a concise representation of key information from legislative documents so that users can obtain an



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overview before consulting the original document. The system therefore combines document digitization, controlled access, summary generation, adjustable summary detail, and direct access to the raw document.

Conceptually, the study will progress from inputs, through system processes, to outputs. The inputs include user and workflow requirements, representative legislative documents, and the identified access and evaluation criteria. The processes include document upload and management, document viewing, AI-assisted summarization, summary-detail selection, permission management, functional testing, and user evaluation. The outputs include a working EcoLegis system and documented evaluation results that will be presented in the succeeding chapter.

Target Clientele

The primary client of the proposed EcoLegis system is the Sangguniang Panlungsod (SP) of Malolos City. The intended users are participants designated by the SP or system administrator. The system is intended to support these users during legislative sessions by providing electronic access to Orders of Business and legislative dockets through authorized devices such as tablets provided by the municipality. Access to documents after a session will depend on the permissions established by the authorized administrator or the SP.

Research Instruments

The study will use instruments appropriate to the requirements-identification, system-development, and system-evaluation stages. These instruments will be finalized and validated according to the academic and institutional requirements of the study.

Requirements Interview Guide. Used to gather information about the current legislative document workflow, user roles, common difficulties, access requirements, and desired system functions from authorized personnel.

Observation Checklist. Used to document how legislative documents are prepared, distributed, accessed, and reviewed during or around legislative sessions.

Document Analysis Form. Used to record the structure, organization, and relevant characteristics of representative Orders of Business or legislative dockets that the system is expected to process.

System Evaluation Questionnaire. Used to obtain feedback from intended users and evaluators regarding the quality and suitability of EcoLegis. The questionnaire will



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contain statements that respondents will rate using a Likert-scale response. The evaluation will cover relevant system quality criteria such as functionality, usability, reliability, maintainability, and other applicable criteria identified by the study. The questionnaire may also include items concerning the readability and usefulness of AI-generated summaries, accessibility of legislative documents, and the overall suitability of the system for legislative session use.

Functional Test Cases. Used to verify whether the major system functions perform as intended, including document upload, document access, AI-assisted summarization, summary-detail selection, raw-document viewing, and permission changes.

Data Gathering Procedure

- 1. Secure Permission.** Permission will first be obtained from the appropriate institutional and academic authorities before conducting interviews, observations, collecting documents, or administering the system evaluation.
- 2. Conduct Initial Interviews and Observations.** Interviews and observations will be conducted with authorized personnel to understand the existing legislative document workflow, user roles, access requirements, and difficulties associated with reviewing lengthy printed materials.
- 3. Collect Representative Documents.** Representative legislative documents, subject to institutional approval and confidentiality requirements, will be collected to determine the structure, organization, and text characteristics that the system must process.
- 4. Identify System Requirements.** The information gathered from the interviews, observations, and document analysis will be analyzed and translated into functional and non-functional system requirements.
- 5. Consolidate Requirements.** The findings from the different data-gathering instruments will be consolidated into a requirements record for the proposed EcoLegis system.
- 6. Validate Requirements.** The identified requirements, intended workflow, and proposed system functions will be presented to appropriate authorized personnel for validation before finalizing the development requirements.
- 7. Develop and Test the System.** The validated requirements will serve as the basis for the design, development, integration, and functional testing of EcoLegis.
- 8. Conduct System Evaluation.** After the system has reached the appropriate testing stage, the selected respondents or evaluators will be provided with an opportunity to use or examine the



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system. They will then accomplish the System Evaluation Questionnaire using the prescribed Likert-scale rating.

9. Collect and Organize Evaluation Responses. Completed questionnaires will be collected, organized, and prepared for statistical analysis. The results will be presented in the succeeding chapter and will not be assumed in this Chapter 3.

10. Document the Results. The findings from the system evaluation, functional testing, and implementation activities will be documented for presentation and interpretation in Chapter 4

Ethical Consideration

The development and evaluation of EcoLegis will observe ethical principles appropriate to research involving government personnel and institutional documents. Permission will be obtained before conducting interviews, observations, document collection, or system evaluation involving the target organization. Participation in interviews and system evaluations will be voluntary, and information gathered from respondents will be used only for the stated academic and system-development purposes.

Because legislative documents may contain sensitive administrative, personal, or operational information, access to actual documents will be limited to authorized materials. The study will avoid unnecessarily reproducing confidential content in the capstone manuscript and will apply appropriate controls when storing or presenting test data.

The system itself is designed around permission-based access, particularly for the period after a legislative session. Access to documents will be provided according to the permissions established by the authorized administrator or intended client.

AI-generated summaries will not be treated as authoritative replacements for official legislative records. Users will be encouraged to consult the raw document whenever exact wording, context, completeness, or verification is necessary.

The respondents' evaluation responses will be treated confidentially. Names and other identifying information will not be disclosed in the final manuscript unless such disclosure is specifically authorized and required by the institution. Evaluation results will be used solely for assessing and improving the proposed system.

Development Process, Testing, and Implementation of the System

The development process is organized into a series of stages that connect the research findings to the working EcoLegis system. The stages are intended to provide a software-development path for implementing the identified legislative document-management and AI summarization requirements.



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- 1. Requirements Analysis.** The document workflow, user roles, access rules, and functions required for legislative session-document review will be identified through interviews, observations, and document analysis.
- 2. Planning and Interface Design.** The information architecture, document-viewing flow, summary controls, user interface, and permission model will be planned based on the validated requirements.
- 3. System Development.** The document-management functions and AI-assisted summarization workflow will be implemented based on the approved requirements.
- 4. System Integration.** The document upload, document viewing, AI summarization, summary-detail selection, raw-document access, and permission-control functions will be integrated into a unified workflow.
- 5. Functional Testing.** Functional test cases will be conducted to determine whether the major system operations perform according to their intended requirements. Any errors or unexpected behavior identified during testing will be recorded for correction.
- 6. System Evaluation.** The intended users or selected evaluators will use or examine the developed system and accomplish the System Evaluation Questionnaire. The respondents will rate the given statements using a Likert-scale response based on the identified evaluation criteria, including functionality, usability, reliability, maintainability, and other applicable criteria.
- 7. Data Analysis and Interpretation.** The responses obtained from the System Evaluation Questionnaire will be organized and analyzed using the appropriate statistical treatment. The resulting findings will be used to determine the perceived quality, usability, and suitability of the system.
- 8. Revision and Retesting.** Necessary corrections or improvements identified during functional testing and system evaluation will be applied. The affected functions will then be tested again to determine whether the identified issues have been addressed.
- 9. Pilot Implementation and Documentation.** The approved pilot or implementation activity will be conducted according to the conditions established by the intended client. Observations and implementation details will be documented for presentation in the succeeding chapter.

Testing will consider both functional correctness and system quality. Functional testing will focus on whether the required operations are successfully completed, while the System Evaluation Questionnaire will gather user and evaluator perceptions regarding the quality and suitability of the system.



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Particular attention will be given to the transition between the AI-generated summary and the raw legislative document, since users should be able to move from a simplified overview to the original source whenever clarification or verification is necessary.

The exact number of respondents, evaluation scores, statistical results, implementation date, and other empirical findings will be recorded after the actual evaluation and implementation activities and will be presented in Chapter 4 rather than assumed in this chapter.



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